

# Amish Sethi

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## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Reliable embodied AI, foundation models that connect video, language, and robot action, scalable neurosymbolic learning, and understanding and adapting large generative models.

## EDUCATION

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**Harvard University** Cambridge, MA  
*Ph.D. in Computer Science, incoming* Fall 2026

Advised by [Heng Yang](#) and [Yilun Du](#). [Kempner Institute Graduate Fellow](#) and NSF Graduate Research Fellow.

**University of Pennsylvania** Philadelphia, PA  
*B.S.E. in Computer Science and M.S.E. in Computer and Information Science* May 2026  
Cumulative GPA 4.00 out of 4.00.

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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- [NSF Graduate Research Fellowship](#), National Science Foundation 2026
- [Kempner Institute Graduate Fellowship](#), Harvard University 2026
- [John Grist Brainerd Award](#), Penn Engineering, top graduating senior 2026
- [CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Award](#), Honorable Mention 2025
- [NeurIPS 2025](#) Spotlight for ESCA, top 3% of submissions 2025
- First Place, International Public Policy Forum 2022
- National Merit Scholar; ISEF Finalist in genetics research 2021

## PUBLICATIONS

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*My name is shown in bold. Authors marked with an asterisk contributed equally.*

Jiani Huang\*, [Brandon Y. Yang\\*](#), **Amish Sethi\***, Yuchen Zheng, Christopher Watson, Jianing Qian, Mayur Naik, Dinesh Jayaraman. “Retrieval-Augmented Vision-Language-Action Model.” Under review at [CoRL](#) 2026. Senior thesis.

**Amish Sethi**, Boya Zeng, Wenhao Chai, Zhuang Liu. “Do Diffusion Models Learn to Generalize Basic Visual Skills.” Under review at [NeurIPS](#).

Zhiqiu Xu\*, **Amish Sethi\***, Mayur Naik, Ser-Nam Lim. “Delta Activations: A Representation for Finetuned Large Language Models.” Under review at [COLM](#); [NeurIPS 2025 ER Workshop](#). [\[arXiv\]](#)

Jiani Huang, **Amish Sethi\***, Matthew Kuo\*, Mayank Keoliya, Neelay Velingker, JungHo Jung, Ziyang Li, Ser-Nam Lim, Mayur Naik. “ESCA: Contextualizing Embodied Agents via Scene-Graph Generation.” [NeurIPS 2025](#), Spotlight, top 3%. [\[Website\]](#)

Aaditya Naik, Jason Liu, Claire Wang, **Amish Sethi**, Saikat Dutta, Mayur Naik, Eric Wong. “Dolphin: A Programmable Framework for Scalable Neurosymbolic Learning.” [ICML 2025](#). [\[arXiv\]](#)

Neelay Velingker, **Amish Sethi\***, Jason Liu\*, William Dodds\*, Zhiqiu Xu, Saikat Dutta, Mayur Naik, Eric Wong. “CLAM: Unifying Finetuning, Quantization, and Pruning by Chaining LLM Adapter Modules.” [ICML 2024 ES-FoMo Workshop](#). [\[Paper\]](#)

Andrew Ni\*, **Amish Sethi\***. “Functional Genetic Biomarkers of Alzheimer’s Disease and Gene Expression from Peripheral Blood.” [bioRxiv](#), 2021. [\[Paper\]](#)

## OPEN-SOURCE AND DATASETS

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- [VINE](#) and the ESCA-Video-87K dataset, a promptable model that turns video into spatio-temporal scene graphs, released on [Hugging Face](#).
- Finetuned and released more than 700 open-source language models on Hugging Face for the Delta Activations study.
- [LASER](#), the codebase behind VINE, reached more than 100 stars on GitHub and was featured on the Google Open Source Blog.

## EXPERIENCE

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### Research Lead

San Francisco, CA

*AfterQuery*

*May 2026 - Present*

- Leading research on the next large benchmark for embodied agents.
- Working to scale robotics data collection well beyond teleoperation, including a more capable handheld interface for in the wild robot demonstrations.

### Research Intern

Singapore

*National University of Singapore*

*2023*

- Built FIIGNET, a generative pipeline that synthesizes images of diseased fish for aquaponics early detection, improving detection accuracy by 17% across synthetic and real datasets.

### Computer Vision Intern

Pittsburgh, PA

*RoadBotics*

*2021*

- Developed a Mask R-CNN model that detects and classifies traffic signs from video with 90% accuracy, deployed by the Pennsylvania state government to maintain an inventory of road assets.

## TEACHING AND SERVICE

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### Head Teaching Assistant, [CIS 7000 Large Language Models](#), Penn

*Fall 2024*

- Planned curriculum, designed assignments, held office hours, and lectured on efficient finetuning, adaptation, and evaluation for Penn's first dedicated LLM course of more than 120 students.

### Undergraduate Research Mentor, [Penn PURM](#)

*Summer 2024*

- Mentored five undergraduates on the CLAM project, teaching research methodology, work with large language models, and scalable optimization.

**Service.** Reviewer for the ICML 2024 ES-FoMo Workshop, [AAAI 2026](#), and [ICLR 2026](#).

Authored a successful [Grant for Faculty Mentoring Undergraduate Research](#), awarded 8,000 dollars by Penn for research on neurosymbolic AI.